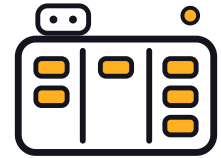


## THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

# Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute AI-and-future-jobs lesson: your class runs a busy recording studio, decides which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay human — and owns the tradeoff behind each choice. Stands alone.

## AT A GLANCE

| TIME   | MATERIALS                                                                                                                                                                                                             | TECH NEEDED                                                  | PREP                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 45 min | Studio Task Board worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; fillable PDF copy included) · Slides (optional; script and keys in the notes) · board + marker for the three columns · Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3) · pens | None — fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides | Print worksheets. That's it. |

## OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Sort real job tasks into **automate** / **augment** / **keep human** and explain the difference. (*Sort the Board; Exit Ticket*)
- Compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong. (*Trade Cards; Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line*)
- Defend a sorting decision aloud: a clear claim, a specific detail, eyes up, voice to the back. (*Defend It — listener strip + Defense Rubric*)

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS ELA SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

## WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: "What's the most boring job you can think of?" Board 4–5 answers, then push on two or three of them:

*"Is it boring because it REPEATS — same thing, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but secretly full of people stuff — helping, noticing, calming someone down?" Sort them as a class: repeats → give it to a robot; people stuff → keep it human. (A cafeteria cashier's job repeats — but the cashier also knows which kid forgot lunch money. Let them argue; the arguing is the point.)*

**Bridge:** "Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse: nobody can promise which jobs change, or how many. So far, it's the boring, repeating parts that get automated — AI takes over tasks, not whole jobs, and nobody can promise the final count. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses something, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those decisions — for a recording studio."

**What if** nobody names a people-stuff job? Offer one: "Bus driver — repeats the route, but notices who's crying in row six."

**Transition:** "So how do you decide what a robot should take? Three columns. Eyes on the board."

## DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THREE COLUMNS, ONE QUESTION (10 MIN)

Draw three columns on the board (slide 4 if projecting) and define them. Say it out loud once: a "call" is a decision.

**AUTOMATE** — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.

**AUGMENT** — a human makes the call, AI helps out.

**KEEP HUMAN** — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.

**Watch one get sorted** (Direct Instruction, continued) — model the tradeoff lens ("the trade") on one task. "Send the 'don't forget your session' texts." Column: AUTOMATE — but don't stop there:

| WHO WINS?                             | WHO LOSES SOMETHING?                                                          | WHAT COULD GO WRONG?                                |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Jaylen — gets hours of his week back. | Jaylen, a little — sending those texts is how he learned every artist's name. | A cheerful reminder lands after a canceled session. |

**Say it plainly:** "The column is the easy part. The trade is the real thinking. In this room, 'because robots' is not a reason. 'Who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong' — that's a reason."

**What if** someone says "automate everything, it's all boring"? "Automate E — the nervous singer gets a chatbot coach. Who lost something?"

**Hand-out / transition:** "One each, pairs of two. Page 1: meet Nia, Ravi and Jaylen; read tasks A to L. Don't sort yet."

## MAIN ACTIVITY — THE STUDIO TASK BOARD (15 MIN)

1. **Sort (8 min):** Pairs write each letter A–L in one of the three tall columns — as many as belong; every column gets at least two. Disagreeing partners talk it out; either can be right. Keep slides 8–9 (the task list) up.

**What if** a pair is stuck? "Does it repeat, or is it people stuff?" Ten letters in AUTOMATE? "Which two would you hate to lose a person on?"

**Transition:** "Pens down. Page 2. Pick the TWO choices you argued about most — those are your trade cards."

2. **Trade cards (7 min):** Each pair picks TWO choices; each student writes the trade on their own sheet — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong.

**What if** an answer is "nobody loses"? Even Jaylen lost something. "Who used to do this task? What did they get from it?"

**Transition:** "Stop there. Now you have to say it out loud — to people who might disagree."

## DEFEND IT — SAY IT OUT LOUD (8 MIN)

**Teach the delivery first (1 min):** "Three moves: eyes up off the page, voice to the back wall, slow down on the word because." **Pairs of pairs (5 min):** two pairs face each other, one student across from each. The claim is the frame on worksheet p.2: "Task \_\_\_ belongs in \_\_\_ because \_\_\_ — and the trade is \_\_\_." Speaker 1 reads their claim out loud (30 seconds), then slides their sheet across. Listener 1 checks the three boxes and writes keep or fix (30 seconds), then slides it back. Switch: Speaker 2 reads, Listener 2 marks. Everyone ends with their own sheet. Each student's claim is scored; you sample 3–4 pairs with the Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3). **Whole class (2 min):** three pairs bring their most-argued choice to the room — or post the boards and gallery-walk for 2 minutes.

**What if** a Speaker reads to the desk? Don't score it: "Eyes on us, one more time." The second try counts. **Odd number of pairs** → one trio of pairs rotates; sample that group. Trio: 20 seconds each, listeners mark the boxes only.

**Transition:** "You already have your own sheet — bottom of page 2. A job you actually know."

## EXIT TICKET (5 MIN)

Worksheet p.2, bottom, solo: the three columns on **a job someone in their life really has** — AUTOMATE also names who loses something; KEEP HUMAN has a why. Collect; exemplar and scoring in the Teacher Guide, p.2.

**What if** a student says "I don't know anyone with a job"? "Your teacher has one. Sort mine."

## DIFFERENTIATION

- **Support:** Sort 8 tasks, not 12 (skip B, F, J, L — every column still gets two); the definitions and claim frame are printed on the sheet.
- **Extension:** Find one task where automating saves money now but hurts the studio in a year — explain the chain.
- **ELL:** Sorting letters keeps writing low; the claim frame doubles as a language frame; argue in any language, present in English.
- **No-device classrooms:** Built in — the whole lesson runs on paper and talk; the slides are optional. With devices: none needed; optionally project the task board.